PixelPush

Complete Pricing Reference

Every cost you pay. Every dollar users pay you.

Pricing & Revenue Document

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Developed by

Aepostrophee

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1. Overview

This document is the single source of truth for all pricing at PixelPush. It is split into two parts: what Aepostrophee pays to run the product (outgoing costs), and what users pay to use the product (incoming revenue). Both sides are broken down across all growth stages — from pre-launch to scale — so financial expectations are clear at every milestone.

How to Read This Document

Part A covers your costs — infrastructure, APIs, and transaction fees. Part B covers user-facing pricing — the free tier, Pro subscription, Lifetime Deal, and all revenue scenarios. Part C brings both sides together into a net profit view.

PART A — YOUR COSTS

Everything Aepostrophee pays to build and operate PixelPush.

2. Infrastructure Costs

2.1 Vercel — Hosting & Serverless Functions

Vercel hosts the Next.js frontend and runs all server-side API routes as serverless functions. PixelPush uses Vercel for page rendering, API routes, cron jobs, and Blob Storage for generated share card images.

Plan	Cost	What It Covers	When to Upgrade
Hobby (Free)	$0 / month	MVP & pre-launch. Personal projects only. No SLA.	0 – 500 users
Pro	$20 / month	Production. Includes $20 usage credits. Required for cron jobs, team access, and commercial use.	500 – 50,000 users
Usage overages	$0.18 / GB bandwidth; $0.60 / million function invocations	Charged above the included credits on Pro plan.	At scale

Cron Jobs Require Pro

PixelPush's daily progress sync — which checks all active users' GitHub graphs — runs as a Vercel Cron Job. Cron jobs are not available on the free Hobby plan. You must upgrade to Pro before activating this feature.

2.2 Neon — PostgreSQL Database

Neon provides serverless PostgreSQL. It stores all user accounts, designs, schedule entries, and Stripe billing fields. Neon scales to zero when idle, keeping costs low in early stages.

Plan	Cost	Included Resources	When to Upgrade
Free	$0 / month	0.5 GB storage · 100 compute-hour/month · 1 project · Scale to zero	0 – 500 users
Launch	$19 / month	10 GB storage · 300 compute-hours/month · Unlimited projects · No scale-to-zero	500 – 5,000 users

Scale	$69 / month	50 GB storage · 750 compute-hours/month · Autoscaling enabled	5,000 – 50,000 users

2.3 Resend — Transactional Email

Resend sends daily schedule reminders, missed-day alerts, milestone emails, and payment failure notifications to users. Email is the fallback channel for users who decline push notifications.

Plan	Cost	Included	When
Free	$0 / month	3,000 emails/month · 1 domain · Basic analytics	0 – 500 users
Pro	$20 / month	50,000 emails/month · 10 domains · Full analytics + webhooks	500 – 5,000 users
Scale	$90 / month	100,000 emails/month · Unlimited domains · Dedicated IPs available	5,000 – 20,000 users
Overage	$1.00 / 1,000 emails above plan limit	Billed automatically at end of month	Any plan

2.4 Anthropic Claude API — AI Project Suggestions

The Claude API powers PixelPush Pro's AI Project Suggestion feature. When a Pro user activates a design, PixelPush sends the user's detected tech stack, theme, and schedule duration to Claude and receives 3 to 5 personalized project ideas in return. This is the only API in the stack that charges per use rather than per month.

Model	Pricing	Notes	Recommendation
Claude Haiku 4.5	$0.25 / million input tokens · $1.25 / million output tokens	Fast, cheapest. Recommended for PixelPush Pro suggestions.	Primary choice
Claude Sonnet 4.6	$3.00 / million input tokens · $15.00 / million output tokens	More nuanced output. Use if suggestion quality needs improvement.	Premium option

Cost Per API Call

Each suggestion call sends approximately 600 input tokens (user repo context + prompt) and receives approximately 500 output tokens (3-5 project suggestions). At Haiku pricing this is $0.0008 per call. At Sonnet pricing this is $0.009 per call. Even at 1,000 Pro users each activating 2 designs per month, Haiku costs under $2/month total.

Usage Scenario	Estimated Monthly AI Cost
50 Pro users · 1 design each/month	~$0.04 (Haiku) / ~$0.45 (Sonnet)
200 Pro users · 2 designs each/month	~$0.32 (Haiku) / ~$3.60 (Sonnet)
500 Pro users · 2 designs each/month	~$0.80 (Haiku) / ~$9.00 (Sonnet)
1,000 Pro users · 2 designs each/month	~$1.60 (Haiku) / ~$18.00 (Sonnet)

2.5 GitHub API

PixelPush uses GitHub's GraphQL API v4 to read users' contribution graphs and public repository data. This API is free for all authenticated users with a rate limit of 5,000 points per hour — far beyond anything PixelPush will consume.

Plan	Cost	Notes	Applies
All usage	$0	Free for all authenticated requests	Always

2.6 Web Push Notifications (VAPID)

Browser push notifications are sent using the open Web Push standard with VAPID keys. There is no third-party service involved and no cost at any scale.

Plan	Cost	Notes	Applies
All usage	$0	Free browser standard. No third-party service required.	Always

2.7 Stripe — Payment Processing

Stripe has no monthly subscription fee. You only pay Stripe when a user pays you. All fees are deducted automatically from each transaction before the remainder is deposited into your bank account.

Fee Type	Amount	Notes

Standard card (Visa, Mastercard, Amex)	2.9% + $0.30 per successful transaction	Applied to every payment
International card surcharge	+1.5% on top of standard rate	When card is issued outside your country
Currency conversion	+1.0% additional	When currency conversion is required
Failed payment retry	$0	No charge for failed attempts
Refund processing	Original fee not returned to you	Stripe keeps the processing fee on refunds
Dispute / chargeback	$15 flat fee per dispute	Reversed if you win the dispute
Stripe Radar (fraud detection)	$0	Free and enabled by default
Customer Portal	$0	Free hosted billing management UI

Net Amount Per Transaction

On a $7.00 monthly charge: Stripe takes $0.50 (2.9% + $0.30), you receive $6.50. On a $35.00 lifetime charge: Stripe takes $1.32 (2.9% + $0.30), you receive $33.68. These fees are already accounted for in the revenue projections in Part B.

2.8 Domain & Subdomain

PixelPush is deployed at pixelpush.aepostrophee.com — a subdomain of Aepostrophee's existing domain. No additional domain purchase is required. DNS configuration is a free CNAME record added to your existing registrar.

Item	Cost	Notes
pixelpush.aepostrophee.com subdomain	$0	Subdomain of existing aepostrophee.com domain
SSL certificate	$0	Auto-provisioned and renewed by Vercel at no charge
DNS hosting	$0	Included with existing domain registrar

3. Total Infrastructure Cost by Growth Stage

The table below shows the combined monthly cost of all services at each stage of PixelPush's growth. AI costs are shown as a range using Haiku (low) and Sonnet (high) pricing.

Stage	Users	Vercel	Neon	Resend	Claude API	GitHub / Push / Domain	Total / Month
Stage 1 — Pre-Launch / MVP	0 – 500	$0	$0	$0	$0 – $0.04	$0	$0 – $0.04
Stage 2 — Early Growth	500 – 5,000	$20	$19	$20	$0.04 – $0.45	$0	$59 – $59.50
Stage 3 — Growth	5,000 – 20,000	$20 – $60	$69	$20 – $90	$0.80 – $9	$0	$110 – $219
Stage 4 — Scale	20,000 – 50,000	$60 – $120	$69	$90	$1.60 – $18	$0	$221 – $298

Key Takeaway — Costs

PixelPush costs $0 per month to run until you have over 500 users. Even at 5,000 users, monthly infrastructure is under $60. At 50,000 users, costs are under $300/month. This is an exceptionally lean cost structure for a SaaS product.

PART B — USER PRICING & YOUR REVENUE

What users pay for PixelPush, and what you receive after Stripe fees.

4. User-Facing Plans

4.1 Free Tier — $0 Forever

The free tier is permanent — not a trial. It provides genuine value and is the primary acquisition channel. Every user starts here. The free tier is designed to be useful enough to keep users engaged, but limited enough that power users feel the pull toward Pro.

Feature	Free Tier
Price	$0 — free forever
Image suggestions per theme	5 per theme selection
Active designs at once	1 design maximum
Themes available	3 — Pets, Scenery, Abstract
Schedule recalculation	1 recalculation per active design
AI Project Suggestions	Not included
Portfolio Fit Score	Not included
Custom image upload	Not included
Org / team graphs	Not included
Social sharing	Enabled — share cards include PixelPush watermark
Timelapse GIF export	Not included
Push / email notifications	Included
Public profile page	Included — pixelpush.aepostrophee.com/u/username
Support	Community documentation only

4.2 PixelPush Pro — $7 / month

Pro is billed monthly and can be cancelled at any time. Access continues until the end of the paid billing period after cancellation. Pro is the primary recurring revenue model for PixelPush.

Feature	PixelPush Pro — $7/month

Price	$7.00 per month · billed monthly · cancel anytime
Stripe fee deducted	$0.50 (2.9% + $0.30)
Net revenue to you	$6.50 per subscriber per month
Image suggestions per theme	8 per theme selection (vs 5 on free)
Active designs at once	3 simultaneous designs
Themes available	All current and future themes + early access
Schedule recalculation	Unlimited — full recovery from missed days at any time
AI Project Suggestions	3 to 5 personalized project ideas per design, matched to user tech stack
Portfolio Fit Score	Interview and portfolio value rating on every suggestion
Custom image upload	Upload any source image for pixel art conversion
Org / team graphs	Contribution art for GitHub organization profiles
Social sharing	Watermark-free share cards
Timelapse GIF export	Included — auto-generated animated completion GIF
Push / email notifications	Included
Public profile page	Included — with Pro badge displayed
Support	Priority support with guaranteed response time

4.3 Lifetime Deal — $35 one-time

The Lifetime Deal gives permanent Pro access for a single upfront payment. It is a launch-phase offer intended to generate upfront revenue, build an early advocate community, and create urgency. It will be capped and eventually retired once PixelPush reaches steady-state monthly subscriber growth.

Detail	Lifetime Deal — $35
Price	$35.00 one-time · no renewal · Pro access permanent
Stripe fee deducted	$1.32 (2.9% + $0.30)
Net revenue to you	$33.68 per sale
Features included	All PixelPush Pro features permanently
Availability	Capped at 200 to 500 redemptions — first-come, first-served

Renewal required	None — Pro access never expires
Future plan upgrades	Lifetime members receive all new Pro features at no additional charge
Recommended positioning	Less than 5 months of Pro — buy once, use forever

Cap the Lifetime Deal

Without a cap, Lifetime Deals can cannibalize monthly subscription revenue long-term. Set a hard limit of 200 to 500 redemptions and display a live counter on the pricing page to create urgency. Close the offer once the cap is reached.

5. Pricing Page Recommendation

The public-facing pricing page at pixelpush.aepostrophee.com/pricing should present three columns clearly. Below is the recommended copy and structure.

Free $0 / month *Forever*	**Pro** $7 / month *Cancel anytime*	**Lifetime** $35 one-time *Limited spots*
5 image suggestions	8 image suggestions	8 image suggestions
1 active design	3 active designs	3 active designs
3 themes	All themes + early access	All themes + early access
1 recalculation	Unlimited recalculations	Unlimited recalculations
—	AI project suggestions	AI project suggestions
—	Portfolio fit scores	Portfolio fit scores
—	Custom image upload	Custom image upload
—	Org graphs	Org graphs
Watermarked shares	Clean share cards + GIF	Clean share cards + GIF
Community support	Priority support	Priority support

6. Revenue Projections

6.1 Monthly Recurring Revenue (Subscriptions Only)

These projections assume the listed conversion rate of free users to paid Pro subscribers. Net MRR is after Stripe's transaction fee of $0.50 per $7.00 charge.

Total Users	Conversion Rate	Pro Subscribers	Gross MRR	Stripe Fees	Net MRR
500 users	3%	15	$105 gross	$7.50 fees	$97.50 net MRR
500 users	5%	25	$175 gross	$12.50 fees	$162.50 net MRR
2,000 users	5%	100	$700 gross	$50 fees	$650 net MRR
2,000 users	8%	160	$1,120 gross	$80 fees	$1,040 net MRR
5,000 users	8%	400	$2,800 gross	$200 fees	$2,600 net MRR
5,000 users	10%	500	$3,500 gross	$250 fees	$3,250 net MRR
10,000 users	10%	1,000	$7,000 gross	$500 fees	$6,500 net MRR
50,000 users	10%	5,000	$35,000 gross	$2,500 fees	$32,500 net MRR

6.2 Lifetime Deal Revenue (One-Time)

The Lifetime Deal generates a single burst of one-time revenue at launch. Net revenue is after Stripe's fee of $1.32 per $35.00 charge.

Lifetime Sales	Gross Revenue	Stripe Fees	Net Revenue
50 sales	$1,750 gross	$66 fees	$1,684 net
100 sales	$3,500 gross	$132 fees	$3,368 net
200 sales	$7,000 gross	$264 fees	$6,736 net
350 sales	$12,250 gross	$462 fees	$11,788 net
500 sales	$17,500 gross	$660 fees	$16,840 net

200 Lifetime Sales + Infrastructure

200 lifetime sales at launch generates $6,736 net — enough to cover approximately 4 months of Stage 2 infrastructure costs ($59/month) while your monthly subscriber base grows. This is the recommended launch strategy.

6.3 Combined Revenue — Realistic Launch Scenario

The following table models a realistic 12-month trajectory starting from launch, combining Lifetime Deal sales in the first month with growing monthly subscriptions.

Month	Stage	Active Paying Users	Gross Revenue	Net Revenue	Infrastructure	Net Profit
Month 1	Launch	200 LTD sales + 30 Pro subs	$6,736 + $195	$6,931	$59	$6,872
Month 2	Post-launch	50 Pro subscribers	$325	$325	$59	$266
Month 3	Growth	80 Pro subscribers	$520	$520	$59	$461
Month 4	Growth	120 Pro subscribers	$780	$780	$59	$721
Month 6	Steady state	200 Pro subscribers	$1,300	$1,300	$59	$1,241
Month 9	Scaling	400 Pro subscribers	$2,600	$2,600	$110	$2,490
Month 12	Established	700 Pro subscribers	$4,550	$4,550	$150	$4,400

7. Break-Even Analysis

Break-even is the point at which monthly revenue from Pro subscribers covers monthly infrastructure costs. Below is the break-even subscriber count at each infrastructure stage.

Infrastructure Stage	Break-Even Point	Notes
Stage 1 — Free tier infra ($0/month)	0 Pro subscribers	Profitable from first sale
Stage 2 — $59/month	10 Pro subscribers	Achievable within days of a launch post
Stage 3 — $110–219/month	17–34 Pro subscribers	Low threshold — reached quickly at this stage
Stage 4 — $221–298/month	34–46 Pro subscribers	Still low relative to user base at this scale

Exceptional Unit Economics

A break-even of 10 subscribers at $59/month infrastructure is extremely lean. Most SaaS products require hundreds of paying users before covering costs. PixelPush's serverless stack makes it profitable at a tiny user base.

PART C — NET PROFIT VIEW

8. Complete Cost vs. Revenue Summary

The table below presents the full financial picture at each growth stage — every outgoing cost against projected net revenue — to show the expected margin at scale.

Stage	Service	Monthly Cost	Net MRR (example)	Stripe Fees (in MRR)	Net Profit
Stage 1 · 0–500 users	Vercel Hobby	$0	—	—	—
	Neon Free	$0	—	—	—
	Resend Free	$0	—	—	—
	Claude API	~$0	—	—	—
	Total Costs	$0/mo	$162.50 net MRR	—	$162.50+
Stage 2 · 500–5,000 users	Vercel Pro	$20	—	—	—
	Neon Launch	$19	—	—	—
	Resend Pro	$20	—	—	—
	Claude API (Haiku)	~$0.32	—	—	—
	Total Costs	~$59/mo	$650–$1,040 net MRR	—	$591–$981+
Stage 3 · 5,000–20,000	Vercel Pro+	$20–$60	—	—	—
	Neon Scale	$69	—	—	—
	Resend Scale	$20–$90	—	—	—
	Claude API (Haiku)	~$0.80	—	—	—
	Total Costs	~$110–$220/mo	$2,600–$3,250 net MRR	—	$2,380–$3,140+
Stage 4 · 50,000 users	Vercel Pro+	$60–$120	—	—	—

	Neon Scale	$69	—	—	—
	Resend Scale	$90	—	—	—
	Claude API (Haiku)	~$1.60	—	—	—
	Total Costs	~$221–$298/mo	$32,500 net MRR	—	$32,200+

8.1 Margin at Scale

PixelPush has extremely high gross margins because the product is software with no physical inventory, no customer success team required at early stage, and infrastructure that scales sublinearly relative to revenue.

Scenario	Net MRR	Monthly Costs	Gross Margin	Notes
500 users · 25 Pro subs	$163/mo	$0/mo	100%	First dollars are pure profit
2,000 users · 160 Pro subs	$1,040/mo	$59/mo	94%	Exceptional for any SaaS product
10,000 users · 1,000 subs	$6,500/mo	$150/mo	97%	Infrastructure barely grows vs revenue
50,000 users · 5,000 subs	$32,500/mo	$298/mo	99%	Near-perfect margin at scale

9. Pricing Decision Guide

This section captures key pricing decisions and the reasoning behind each one, for future reference when revisiting or adjusting the pricing model.

Decision	Rationale
Why $7/month for Pro?	Positioned below the $10 psychological threshold. Cheap enough to be an impulse purchase for a developer, meaningful enough to generate real MRR. Comparable to a domain name or one coffee per month.
Why $35 for Lifetime?	Exactly 5 months of Pro. Positioned as 'buy once, save forever' for early believers. High enough to generate meaningful launch revenue, low enough to convert hesitant users.
Why cap the Lifetime Deal?	Unlimited lifetime deals eventually cannibalize subscription revenue. A cap of 200–500 creates urgency, limits long-term revenue dilution, and keeps the core model subscription-based.
Why not charge more for Pro?	Developer tools in this category (profile tools, productivity apps) typically price at $5–10/month. PixelPush is a fun creative tool, not a mission-critical utility. Volume at $7 beats lower volume at $15.
Why is AI suggestions a Pro feature?	It has a real per-call cost (Claude API), it delivers career value worth paying for, and it is technically differentiated. It is the feature most likely to convert free users to Pro.
Why no annual plan at launch?	Annual plans reduce churn but lock in revenue at a discount and add billing complexity. Launch with monthly only and introduce an annual option (e.g. $60/year = 2 months free) once monthly retention data is established.

10. Glossary

Term	Definition
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue. Total monthly income from all active Pro subscribers.
Net MRR	MRR after Stripe transaction fees are deducted.
Gross Margin	Revenue minus direct costs, expressed as a percentage of revenue. For software, this excludes infrastructure and API costs.
LTD	Lifetime Deal. A one-time payment for permanent access to a subscription product.
Conversion Rate	The percentage of free users who upgrade to a paid plan.
Churn	The percentage of paid subscribers who cancel in a given month. Low churn is critical for healthy MRR growth.
ARPU	Average Revenue Per User. Total MRR divided by total paying users. For PixelPush Pro, ARPU is $7 minus Stripe fees = $6.50.
Break-Even	The number of paying subscribers required for monthly revenue to equal monthly infrastructure costs.
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost. What it costs on average to acquire one paying customer. For PixelPush, viral sharing is the primary channel so CAC is near zero.
LTV	Lifetime Value. The total net revenue expected from a single subscriber over their lifetime. At $6.50/month net with average 6-month retention, LTV = ~$39.

PixelPush — Complete Pricing Reference v1.0

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